



THE BOUNDLESS BRIEF · FREE RESOURCE

The 4-Part Filter for Clearer Decisions

Before you believe, share, or decide, run it through these four questions. It takes about a minute, and it will save you from a lot of confident mistakes.

- 1 Who's the source, and what do they gain?**
Not just whether they seem credible. What does this specific person or outlet get if you believe them, attention, a sale, a tribe? Incentives don't make something false, but they tell you where to look harder.
- 2 Have you heard the strongest version of the other side?**
Not the strawman that's easy to dismiss, the best argument a smart person who disagrees would make. If you can't state it fairly, you don't understand the issue yet. You just have a side.
- 3 What does the evidence say, versus the story?**
Stories are sticky; base rates are boring and usually right. One vivid anecdote is not data. What happens on average, to most people, most of the time?
- 4 What does it cost you if you're wrong?**
Low stakes and reversible? Decide fast and move. High stakes and hard to undo? Slow down and widen your inputs. Match your rigor to your risk.

The goal isn't to be certain. It's to decide deliberately, from well-rounded information, instead of reacting to whatever was loudest in your feed.